

The math meets the market.

Yesterday's margin meets the room it has to live in.

One sentence, one margin per customer.

YESTERDAY'S SENTENCE

Payer pays price per unit for value.

Tomás: his parents pay €8 a month for a practice app he will keep opening.

YESTERDAY'S MARGIN (Z)

€8 – €5 = €3 per customer.

Thin but positive. This is the number we multiply today.

Two traps to name before we draw anything.

TRAP ONE

Numbers look like proof.

A confident projection is a stack of assumptions.
Each one is a decision you can still get wrong.

TRAP TWO

SAM is where founders lie to themselves.

A defensible-sounding middle number that's actually
a guess on a guess. We're going to skip it on purpose.

Two thousand four hundred Tomáses. Do they exist?

THE MATH	
Margin per customer	€3
Fixed costs / month	€7,200
Break-even	2,400
<i>The number is customers, not euros.</i>	

THE QUESTION

A break-even count is meaningless without a market to compare it to.



THE ROOM

How many Tomásés exist in Lisbon?

Not "EU teens." Not "families who care." Specifically.

How many of your payers exist in your city?

Pick a number now. Write it down. We will not reveal what's true today. That's tomorrow morning's opener.

HOLD THE ANSWER • REVEAL TOMORROW

Show all three. Do only the one that loads.

TAM • CONTEXT

The whole market. Context only, never the target.

EU teens.

SAM • SKIP BY DESIGN

~~**Where founders lie to themselves. A guess on a guess.**~~

~~*EU families paying for instrument lessons.*~~

SOM • THE WORK

What you can actually reach. Bottom-up only.

Lisbon parents of teens 13–17 who bought instrument lessons in 90 days.

Honest unit, break-even, SOM bottom-up, then the hinge.

STEP ONE	Honest unit.	Every cost in. Acquisition included.
STEP TWO	Break-even.	Fixed costs over margin. The number is customers, not euros.
STEP THREE	SOM bottom-up.	Real channel, real reachable count. Not "% of SAM."
STEP FOUR	The hinge.	Break-even vs SOM. The gap is the verdict.

Put the two numbers next to each other. Read the gap.

Break-even customers vs **SOM** customers → **gap** .

THE VERDICT

If $SOM \geq \text{break-even}$, you have a hypothesis worth testing. If $SOM < \text{break-even}$, you have the killer.

TOMÁS, AS A WORKED FILL

Break-even 2,400 customers vs SOM 1,800 customers → gap -600. The model dies in Lisbon. That's a useful finding, not a failure.

Your turn.

HONEST UNIT +
BREAK-EVEN

**Margin then
customers.**

25 min · do first

SOM BOTTOM-UP

**Real channel,
real count.**

25 min · the work

THE HINGE

**Side by side. Read
the gap.**

15 min · the spine

KILLER & MOAT

**What kills it, and
what protects it.**

8 min

Margin per customer, then customers to break even.

+	Revenue per customer	€___
-	Product cost	€___
-	Acquisition (the skipped one)	€___
-	Support	€___
= Margin per customer		€___

MARGIN ALL COSTS IN • BREAK-EVEN-AS-CUSTOMERS

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Fixed costs ÷ margin = break-even

The result is a count of customers. Write that number down.

THE TEST

If acquisition cost is missing, the unit is fiction. Put it back in. If margin is negative, stop and name it.

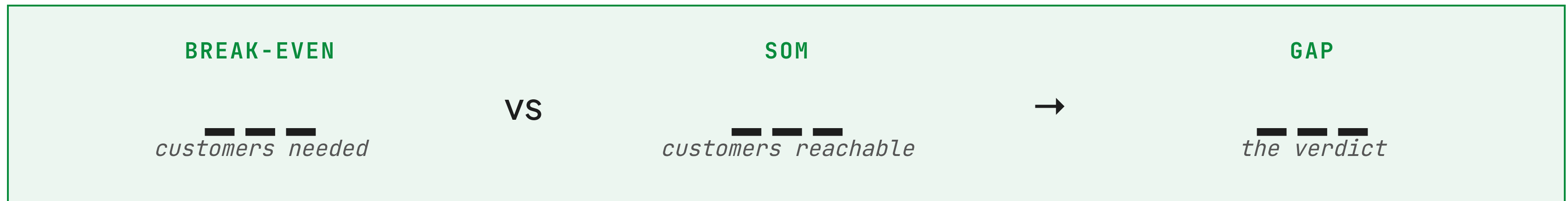
Real channel. Real reachable count. One reference point per number.

- 01 Name one real reachable channel. Geography, community, distribution.
- 02 Estimate channel size with one reference point. Search volume, community, census.
- 03 Apply a defensible conversion. Cite where it came from.
- 04 Commit to one SOM number.

REJECT

If the reference is "the AI said so," rebuild it.

Side by side. Compute the gap. Read the verdict.



- 01 Write the two numbers side by side.
- 02 Compute the gap. SOM minus break-even.
- 03 Write the verdict. "Testable, gap [N]" or "Dies, shortage [N]."

ONE-LINE VERDICT • OUT LOUD

What kills it, and what keeps it yours.

YOUR KILL LINE

This model fails if SOM is ___ **OR** break-even is ___ .

YOUR MOAT

If this works, what stops someone copying it? If nothing does, that is worth knowing too.

KILLER NAMED • MOAT NAMED

The room either holds the model, or names the killer.



BREAK - EVEN

Customers needed.
Fixed costs over
honest margin.



SOM

Bottom-up from a
real channel. One
reference point.



THE GAP

Positive = hypothesis
to test. Negative =
killer named.



KILLER & MOAT

What ends the model,
and what protects it.

Take the number into this afternoon. M owns the methodology. You own the number.

Real conversations test the room.

THIS AFTERNOON • OUT IN MARKET #1

Test whether your SOM is fiction.

M owns the methodology. You own the number.

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TOMORROW • B3M3 100-DAY PLAN

The room-prediction reveals.

Your validated SOM feeds the 100-day customer trajectory.